

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical litigation support experience gained at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner and Citizens Advice. Experienced in preparing hearing bundles, conducting legal research, drafting procedural documents, maintaining organised electronic case files and managing competing deadlines across active matters. Comfortable communicating with clients on sensitive matters and supporting fee earners across a varied caseload. Currently completing an LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution at Queen Mary University of London.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit (in progress) Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules covering international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and legal research
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module — 75%
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction to submission: takes detailed client statements, establishes chronologies, prepares correspondence and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex legal points

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline, coordinating documents, tracking outstanding actions and helping ensure on-time filing
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian-language translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials

- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Handled matter opening and closure, court filings, hearing arrangements and deadline tracking using iManage
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; prepared client notes and maintained matter records

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the matter deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, evidence review, procedural histories, electronic case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters